# Payrolls Collapse

*NFP −92,000 — worst since COVID. Oil breaks $90. VIX +25% to 29.66. S&P −1.36% for its worst week since October.*

## THE SESSION

**Payrolls collapsed. The labor market just broke. February nonfarm payrolls came in at −92,000 — the worst print since the pandemic and a massive miss against the +56,000 consensus. Unemployment ticked up to 4.4%. The S&P 500 fell 1.36% to 6,738.15, the Nasdaq dropped 1.60%, and the Dow lost 0.95%. The Russell 2000 cratered 2.33% as small-caps absorbed the double blow of weakening employment and surging energy costs. The VIX exploded 24.88% to 29.66 — its highest level since the October 2025 crash. 434 of the S&P 500's components closed red.**

Oil was the other hammer. WTI broke above $90 per barrel — ending the week up 35%, the largest weekly gain since oil futures trading began in 1983. Brent topped $90. Trump posted that there will be no deal without "unconditional surrender" from Iran, killing any hope of near-term de-escalation. Qatar's energy minister warned oil could double to $150 if the war continues. The stagflation trade is now fully priced: weak jobs plus surging energy equals a Fed trapped between cutting for growth and holding for inflation.

BlackRock curbed withdrawals from a $26B private-credit fund, adding financial-sector contagion fear to the mix. Blue Owl tanked 6%, Blackstone and Bridgewater fell 4%. Marvell surged 22% on strong earnings — one of the few bright spots. The Atlanta Fed's GDPNow tracker plunged to 2.1% from 3.0% on Monday. This was the S&P's worst week since October.

***IOWN Tactical: S&P at ~6,738. Still above our –20% buy trigger (~5,800 from ATH). The war premium is no longer compressing — it's accelerating. March 19 FOMC is the next decision point. Swaps now pricing a single cut this year instead of multiple.***

## IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

### WINNERS

**LMT +2.56%** DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Defense is the war's direct beneficiary. Lockheed rallied as the conflict showed no signs of de-escalation. Hit $672.86 intraday.

**ADP +1.60%** DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Payroll processing thrives regardless of whether payrolls are up or down — companies still need to process. ADP hit $226.50, its best level this month.

**GFI +0.68%** GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold surged 1.74% to $5,167 as safe-haven flows returned. Gold Fields was the only gold miner to close green — AEM fell 0.22%.

**OKE +1.55%** GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Midstream energy benefits directly from elevated crude prices and pipeline throughput demand.

**PDD +1.22%** GROWTH PORTFOLIO

China e-commerce held firm as a non-correlated play. Temu's global expansion continues to drive the narrative.

**CL +0.96%** DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Consumer staples caught a defensive bid. Colgate is the type of name investors reach for when fear spikes to 29.

**CHD +0.84%** DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Church & Dwight rallied with the staples rotation. Household products demand is recession-proof.

**GD +0.77%** DIVIDEND STRATEGY

General Dynamics added to defense gains. Aerospace and combat systems demand accelerating.

### DECLINERS

**MARA –8.67%** GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Bitcoin plunged 3.87% and crypto miners amplified the carnage. Marathon fell to $8.01 — below its March 3 low.

**HUT –8.35%** GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Hut 8 gave back nearly all of Wednesday's +13.89% surge. The $54-to-$47 round-trip in three days.

**LRCX –7.15%** DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Lam Research was destroyed. AI chip permit fears plus energy-cost pressure on Korean fabs hammered semi equipment.

**ETHA –5.41%** DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Ethereum sold off harder than Bitcoin. The crypto complex reversed the entire Wednesday rally.

**MATX –3.63%** DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Matson cratered on shipping disruption fears. Container rates volatile with Hormuz traffic frozen.

**STLD –4.41%** DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Steel Dynamics fell on tariff margin compression and weakening industrial demand signals from the payrolls report.

**KEYS –4.25%** GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Keysight continued its slide on AI chip export restriction fears. Down over 9% in two sessions.

**IBIT –4.35%** DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Bitcoin ETF sold off as risk assets broadly repriced. BTC dropped to $68,145 — erasing the entire Wednesday breakout.

## PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT ONE

**–1.45%**

vs. DVY –0.65% | IWS –1.64%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✗ TRAIL

**–2.21%**

vs. IUSG –1.58%

**YEAR-TO-DATE**

Dividend +7.87% vs DVY +7.72% / IWS +4.47%

Growth –1.42% vs IUSG –4.61%